Condition Account Pipeline

Measuring ecosystem health with the Condition Index (CI: 0-1)

A No field data

1. **Remote sensing proxies**
   SST, Degree Heating Weeks (DHW), Chlorophyll-a, turbidity
2. **Literature reference levels**
   Use published thresholds from peer-reviewed studies
3. **Qualitative assessment**
   Score condition based on available proxies

   Low confidence

B Field surveys available

1. **Field data collection**
   Underwater Visual Census, quadrats, transects, eDNA
2. **Select indicators + set reference levels**
   Choose metrics relevant to ecosystem type; define reference condition
3. **Normalize indicators**

   Higher-is-better: `CI = V / Ref`
   Higher-is-worse: `CI = 1 - (V / Ref)`
   Cap at 0 and 1
4. **Aggregate across sites**
   Mean CI with standard error (SE) across monitoring stations

SEEA EA Condition Account

Ecosystem type x indicator x reference level x CI score x opening/closing

WORKED EXAMPLE Coral cover = **20%** / Reference = **50%** = **CI = 0.40**